

Adapted Paper 2 Subject: Lenin, Stalin and the Rise of the USSR

Read sources A to D and answer questions 1 to 4. The sources and questions relate to the Soviet Union under Stalin and his policy of collectivization.

Source A

An extract from Stalin's speech to administrators after he visited Siberia in January 1928,

Taken from *Collected Works*, by J.V. Stalin, Moscow, 1955

You have had a bumper harvest ... your grain surpluses this year are bigger than ever before. Yet the plan for grain procurement [something obtained by effort] is not being fulfilled. Why? Look at the kulak farms: their barns and sheds are crammed with grain ... You say that the kulaks are unwilling to deliver grain, that they are waiting for prices to rise, and prefer to engage in unbridled [unlimited] speculation. That is true. But the kulaks are demanding an increase in prices three times those fixed by the government ... But there is no guarantee that the kulaks will not again sabotage the grain procurements next year. It may be said with certainty that as long as there are kulaks, there will be sabotage of grain procurements.

Source B

Opinion of a member of the Ukrainian Central Committee in 1930

taken from *The Harvest of Sorrow*, by Robert Conquest, senior research fellow at the Hoover Institution, Oxford, 1986.

The peasant is adopting a new tactic. He refuses to reap the harvest. He wants the bread grain to die in order to choke the Soviet government with the bony hand of famine. We will show him what famine is. Your task is to stop the kulak sabotage of the harvest. You must bring it in to the last grain and immediately send it off to the delivery point. The peasants are not working. They are counting on previously harvested grain they have hidden in pits. We must force them to open their pits.

Source C

Extract from *Stalin and His Hangmen*, by Donald Rayfield, professor of Russian literature at the University of London, London, 2005.

Stalin's entourage [followers] were enslaved to doctrine. The kulak was to be eliminated even though he was rarely rich enough to be an exploiter but often employed poor peasants, giving them corn to survive the winter ... even worse, to meet targets for confiscation, middle peasants were arrested as kulaks. The idiocy of Stalin's policy was that the peasants who could farm the land and worked hard were turned off it, very often to die, and those who could not farm and would not work inherited the earth as members of the collective farms ... Why was there no effective protest from within or outside the party at this campaign of unprovoked violence against the class that all of Russian society professed to be the core of the nation? Was it ignorance of what was happening? Did people believe the Stalinist propaganda ... Did dissenters fear deadly reprisals? All three factors deterred intellectuals and party workers from taking a stand. The deafening silence must lead us to conclude that Stalin's apparatus on the one hand and the OGPU the other had, by 1928, established their reputations for omniscience [knowledge of all things] and ruthless intolerance.

Source D

"Statistics showing agricultural output and state procurement of grain 1928-1935",
from AN ECONOMIC HISTORY OF THE USSR 1917-1991 by Alec Nove

	1928	1929	1930	1931	1932	1933	1934	1935
Grain harvest (million tons)	73.3	71.7	83.5	69.5	69.6	68.4	67.6	75.0
State procurement of grain (million tons)	10.8	16.1	22.1	22.8	18.5	22.6	1# -	2#
Grain exports (million tons)	0.03	0.18	4.76	5.06	1.73	1.69	-	-
Cattle (million head)	70.5	67.1	52.3	47.9	40.1	38.4	42.4	49.3
Pigs (million head)	26.0	20.4	13.6	14.4	11.6	12.1	17.4	22.6
Sheep and goats (million head)	146.7	147.0	108.8	77.7	52.1	50.2	51.9	61.1

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Read sources A to D and answer questions 1 to 4. The sources and questions relate to the Soviet Union under Stalin and his policy of collectivization.

Questions:

- 1a. According to Source C, what were the effects on agriculture of the elimination of the kulaks? [3 marks]
- 1b. What message is conveyed by Source D about agricultural output and state procurement of grain between 1928 and 1933? [2 marks]
2. With reference to its origin, purpose, and content, analyze the value and limitations of Source C for a historian studying collectivization under Stalin. [4 marks]
3. Compare and contrast the views on collectivization expressed in Sources A and B [6 marks]
4. Using the sources and your own knowledge, to what extent do you agree that "collectivization was a political success but an economic failure"? [9 marks]

16/24

1a

2/3

not an "affair in the"

One effect on agriculture that eliminating the kulaks had was the employment of those who could not farm to produce grain, ~~in place~~ in place of experienced ~~farmers~~ kulak farmers. Another effect was the creation of collectivist farms that jointly collected grain and animals for the state. Another effect was that the ~~reformed~~ newly employed inexperienced farmers "would not work", leading to a loss in grain yields.

1b

1/2

One message is ~~the loss of yields on cattle and livestock~~, ~~the inefficiency~~ the inefficiency that collectivization had on boosting livestock ~~growth~~ ^{Not mentioned in the prompt} yields, marked by a steep fall in output compared to other agricultural benchmarks. Another message is ~~the state's grain production~~ ~~state got more involved~~ that the state procurement of grain doubled due to the collectivization scheme, ~~seen as~~ ^{seen as} state procurement doubled ~~between 1928 and 1932~~ during the first 5-year plan.

2

2.5/4

One value of Source C is its origin in the early 21st century. Rayfield's book provides a modern interpretation and presentation of Soviet dealings with kulaks ~~that~~ that can help contextualize this in a language that ~~historians in the~~ ^{Access to Archives} ^{highlight} ^{→ synthesize decades of scholarship} current historians in the Western world ~~are~~ are prone to understand.

0.5

Be specific on the bias against Stalin or Communism

One limitation of Source C is its origin from a Western scholar based in the United Kingdom. Rayfield ~~is~~ interacts with this topic with a ~~Western~~ ^{Western} lens that usually assigns a revisionist, antagonizing characteristic to Stalin's policies, which may pose ~~interest~~ ^{interest} and/or perpetuate intrinsic subjective biases ^{in a historian}.

One value of ~~the~~ Source C is its purpose in ~~trying~~ ^{trying} to understand a certain phenomenon during kulak prosecution. Rayfield, in this excerpt, ~~contextualizes and the state~~ attempts to investigate why people were

- informs → Stalin's violence & repression
- persuade →
- public understanding of Stalin's policies
- may exaggerate Stalin's brutality
- underpins farmer/collectivization perspectives

Purpose of a critical perspective

A small, dark, rectangular object, possibly a piece of wood or metal, with some faint markings.

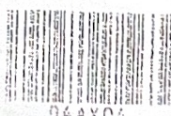
- 3.

4/4

- underlying assumption - this is an act against sacred communions.

- on the role that parents played during collectivization

deliberate
destruction



Ukrainian farmers striking. Another difference is ~~the~~ how they describe the kulaks' ~~the~~ intent. While A characterizes kulaks as hoarders and perpetrators of the bourgeoisie, B directly calls the striking ~~the~~ farmers out as enemies of the state.

4

6.5/9

Good line to 54p
but clearer categories
would help

Stalin's policies of collectivization accompanied his 5 year plans as staples of ~~the economic~~ the economic policies under his reign — but they were ~~not~~ perhaps not as much ~~as~~ of an economic success as Stalin ~~was~~ would've wanted. Collectivization ~~was~~ was economically unfruitful — it helped to ~~rebalance~~ rebalance industrialization ~~in~~ adjunct to the ~~5-year~~ First 5 year plan, but it came at the cost of millions of deaths and falling yield rates. That wasn't all too bad for Stalin though — it helped him consolidate much political power. *This last sentence is general, non-academic, and doesn't offer what to be unpaired (specific)*

→ Collectivization ~~had its perks~~ ^{not academic} — it helped to ~~prop~~ ^{prop} Russian industrialization and achieve Stalin's economic goals. Those were to ~~catch up~~ catch up quickly to industrialized nations — Stalin famously said that if Russia doesn't industrialize, they'll go ~~in~~ under. Under collectivization, state procurement of grain jumped from ~~12.8~~ 12.8 million to 22.8 million tons (src D) across the first five year plan, which ~~helped~~ funneled food into industrial centers like Petrograd and Muncitogorsk. As this was essential to the rapid ~~industrial~~ outputs ~~and~~ of heavy industry materials and manufacturing, ~~collectivization~~ collectivization led to this facet of economic success.

However, collectivization was more ill than good, ~~in the~~ in the heartlands of peasants and the ~~the~~ statist charts. To consolidate collectivization and state control of farms, Stalin called for

^{why?}
the elimination of the kulaks, antagonizing them as "sabotagers of the grain procurement" (src A). As ~~prosecution~~ prosecution of kulaks ensued, ~~but~~ but the truth was that the kulaks & Stalin attempted to eliminate were "peasants who could farm the land" (source C) that actually knew how to farm. As collectivized farms are now filled with incompetent farmers, yields dropped compared to before ~~that the~~ collectivization and livestock yields were decimated. In this regard, Stalin's removal of ~~the~~ agricultural faculty led to ~~as a result of~~ is characteristic of economic failure.

However, Stalin's egregious acts actually helped consolidate much of the power ~~for~~ for his administration and himself. the deportation of kulaks was a major agenda that instilled fear in peasants, ~~with~~ with the state carrying "omniscience and ruthless intolerance" (src C) to mention that deliberate show of "what famine is" to Ukrainian farmers, that resulted in the Holodomor (src B). Stalin's ruthless treatment of deviators of ~~the~~ collectivization had led to not only real prosecution of peasants and landlords alike, but also the wide, ^{more} powerful nation of all-knowing and punishing to normal civilians, instilling a fear that bolstered Stalin's ~~control~~ control over the masses and can be counted as an emphatic political success.

In summation, Stalin's agenda of collectivization had ~~its~~ ~~pros~~

- Very good explicit use of the Sources & some evaluation though not sustained
- You're well on your way to being able to expand your extent and depth of evaluation.

Why did Stalin need to do this? What aspects of Power does he consolidate?